



Candidate pack

Role: Project Support Officer



British Heart
Foundation



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Appointment of Project Support Officer

Dear Candidate,

Thank you for your interest in our role of Project Support Officer at British Heart Foundation (BHF).

It is my privilege to lead the Technology team for one of the UK's largest charities and the nation's leading independent funder of heart and circulatory disease research.

British Heart Foundation is strong, highly effective and well respected nationally and internationally. Every day we turn to research for hope, which is funded solely by the generosity of our supporters. At BHF, we know the only way to get closer to a world free from the fear of heart and circulatory diseases is to invest in pioneering research that has the greatest potential to improve and save lives.

As a Project Support Officer you'll support workstreams within a strategic programme. Main functions include co-ordination of project information for internal and external project stakeholders; provide key communication updates; monitor work and progress against plans; offer vital assistance to project management team; prepare reports and supporting documentation, prepare project board meetings, and ensure projects remain compliant with PMO standards at all times.

We want an exceptional colleague who exemplifies and champions our values; brave, informed, compassionate and driven. It's an incredibly exciting time to be part of our team. We are more ambitious and determined than ever – because the potential cures and treatments we need are in sight. You could be part of getting us there sooner, so thank you for your interest.

BHF is also proud that we are working towards being a truly diverse organisation, with an Equality, Diversity and Inclusion (EDI) strategy, Igniting Change, which sets out a roadmap of the changes we want to see by 2025. Our growing commitment to equality and diversity spans across our organisation and we pride ourselves in being an inclusive employer who puts diversity at the heart of everything that we do.

So, if you feel you have the skills and experience that we are looking for, and you share our determination to help fund lifesaving research, then we would be delighted to hear from you.

Akex Duncan

Chief Technology Officer





"CPR and heart surgery saved my life when I was six. Research made that happen." - Jady Briggs

About British Heart Foundation

For more than 60 years, British Heart Foundation has been at the forefront of cutting-edge research that has saved and improved millions of lives. But, despite this progress, our work is needed more than ever today. Over 7 million people are living with heart and circulatory diseases in the UK - that's our parents, grandparents, children and siblings. Heart and circulatory conditions remain the biggest killers globally.

We raise money to fund research that helps to save and improve lives, and to support people affected by heart and circulatory diseases. These diseases can affect anyone.

For over 60 years we've been a leading independent funder of research into heart and circulatory diseases. We are the UK's largest charity retailer with around 700 stores, an employee base of over 4,000, supported by a further 18,000 volunteers.

Our lifesaving work is primarily advanced through long-term investment in medical research. We have £437 million of BHF-funded research underway, with an aspiration to invest in excess of £1 billion in research over the next ten years.

We have so much to be proud of. But we know we're just scratching the surface of our true potential. And the challenges we face are as grave as ever.

There is nothing more precious than our hearts. But the tragic reality is that millions of people's hearts are at risk. Mounting numbers of people face an agonising wait for care, while many more live in hope of treatments and cures that could save or improve their lives.

At the same time, we stand at the precipice of revolutionary scientific advances. From unleashing the power of artificial intelligence (AI) and Data Science which could stop heart attacks and strokes, to finding revolutionary gene editing cures to end sudden cardiac death.

We need more support. By joining British Heart Foundation, you could help us bring hope to people living with heart and circulatory diseases in the UK.



Being a responsible charity

We've become a more socially, environmentally and financially sustainable organisation.

Our core purpose is to save and improve the lives of people affected by heart and circulatory diseases. We raise money to fund research to find cures and develop treatments for the world's biggest killers. And we are determined to do this in a responsible way.

Climate change, environmental sustainability and social inequality are some of the critical challenges of our time and are clearly highlighted in the UN's Sustainable Development Goals. Our own health is dependent on the planet we inhabit, and the way societies are structured, which are often unfair and unequal on its people. We recognise our responsibility and the important role we play in tackling these issues.

Our strategy to 2030 highlights our commitment to being a healthy and inclusive place to work and a leading force for good in society. We are proud of our progress in the area. Our retail activities contribute significantly to the UK's economy and communities. Our EDI 'Igniting Change' strategy demonstrates

our commitment to improving equality, diversity and inclusion in all areas of our work, and we have programmes underway to reduce the environmental impact in many areas – from our transport to our supply chains. But we want and need to do more.

In response to soaring energy costs, we formed an Energy Efficiency Task Force and launched an energy awareness campaign, You Have the Power, to share energy saving information with BHF colleagues and volunteers.

Overall we were able to reduce our consumption by 10% over 2022-23. We will continue to explore energy efficiency improvements and to give our staff and volunteers more power to reduce energy consumption while providing a safe and comfortable working environment.

Funding animal research is not a decision we take lightly. You can read more relating to our commitments in research [here](#).

Our strategy to 2030

Inspiring support, accelerating breakthroughs,
saving lives.

BHF has never been more needed.
But we're poised and ready to meet this
moment.

Our strategy is a commitment to
helping achieve this vision, and sets
out the objectives and activities we will
prioritise in the years ahead.





Team BHF attending
Birmingham Pride 2023

Equality, diversity & inclusion

Our push for equality, diversity and inclusion takes many forms, including how we manage our organisation, and how our research funding helps to tackle health inequalities.

Reducing heart and circulatory disease health inequalities is an important part of our strategy to 2030. The ongoing work of Kaleidoscope, our equality, diversity and inclusion group, as well as our Research Inequalities Working Group, demonstrate our commitments to improve equality, diversity and inclusion for our staff, our volunteers, and our funding activities. We want all of our BHF colleagues to have development and progression opportunities, and to embed a more inclusive culture throughout our organisation. Our EDI strategy, Igniting Change, sets out our roadmap of the changes we want to see by 2025.

Our Kaleidoscope group is made up of representatives from across the organisation. Our activities encompass accessibility to work and progression for those with care responsibilities, working parents, those with disabilities and long term health conditions, different age groups, those from underrepresented ethnic backgrounds, LGBTQ+ individuals and many more forms of diversity, visible and invisible.

We have a number of affinity groups within the organisation. These include spaces for working parents, individuals from different religious, racial, and ethnic backgrounds, members of the LGBTQ+ community and those with disabilities and long term health conditions. These are designed to be spaces for colleagues to feel connected, included and heard.

Whilst working for BHF, we actively encourage our colleagues to feel safe to bring their true selves to work. We strive to create a culture where colleagues are inquisitive about diversity and keen to get involved in all activities which make individuality and inclusivity part of what we do every single day.

We want to fund lifesaving research for everyone. We can help to achieve this by welcoming colleagues from all backgrounds to come and be part of our BHF family.

Building an inclusive and supportive environment

Many heart and circulatory diseases are diseases of inequality. We are committed to funding lifesaving science for everyone, and we are committed to being an inclusive employer.

At BHF we want to ensure our workforce reflects the general population of the United Kingdom, so we can better represent the experiences and voices of the communities we support. A more diverse, inclusive, and fair BHF will not only improve the quality of what we do, but the impact we have.

Staff engagement

Listening to our colleagues, and understanding what matters, is always the first step in improving the employee experience.

Our wide-ranging employee survey received record support (69%), and attracted 19,000 comments and views. Our engagement score, one of the most important measures we track, was maintained at 7.5 out of 10.

Heartfest

In June 2022 we held our first Heartfest, an online festival that brought BHF colleagues together to celebrate our work and give everyone a chance to reconnect with each other and to our cause. The various interactive sessions featured colleagues, patients, researchers and supporters sharing inspiring stories, with music and wellbeing sessions adding to the festival feel.

Heartfest returned in 2023, bigger and better, and incorporated both online and in person events at BHF offices and shops across the UK.



Becky's story

Becky Newham, Senior Manager, Planning and Performance: "I'm 38 and have been living with sight loss since the age of 8. I've worked with various individuals across the organisation to raise awareness of some of the challenges I face and improve some of our ways of working. For me to be fully included it requires support from everyone on an ongoing basis."

Celebrating Pride

Pride is a chance for us to learn and show support for the LGBTQ+ community. BHF colleagues took part in Pride events across the country, including Edinburgh, Birmingham and London Pride events.

These are our values

We are proud that the work we do is funding groundbreaking, lifesaving research that one day could see a world free from the fear of heart and circulatory diseases, including conditions such as heart attacks, stroke and vascular dementia.

That's why our values are key to defining who we are, how we do things and how we can achieve our ambitions so that every pound we raise funds the science that keeps millions of hearts beating.



We're brave

We speak out. We're decisive. We're innovative.



We're compassionate

We're open and honest. We respect others. We care.



We're informed

We're clear. We're open minded. We're work together.



We're driven

We're focused. We're determined. We keep learning.



Our benefits

We all achieve more together when we're happy and healthy

As a world class organisation, we offer competitive salaries and an attractive package of benefits, designed to support the health and wellbeing of everyone who works here.

Our generous benefits include:



Annual leave

Our annual leave allowance of 30 days plus bank holidays is among the best in the sector.



Healthcare

We offer employees private healthcare, dental health cover and a contribution towards your gym membership.



Family leave

We offer 12-weeks' pay package for all family leave including maternity, paternity and adoption leave and are committed to offering returning parents and guardians the opportunity to work flexibly.



Live well. Work well.

Heart health is central to our mission, and that starts with you. We provide a programme of activities, opportunities and guidance to inspire and support you to live a healthy and happy life, at home and at work.



Support leave

We offer a holistic support leave of up to 10 days leave to support colleagues in time of uncertainty, where you may need to take additional time away from work to support yourself or others during a life event, such as caring responsibilities, bereavement, and specialised medical appointments.



Pension

Our generous pension scheme will support you to save for your retirement. You can contribute a minimum of 3% but can increase this to 8% or more, with employer contribution starting at 5% and increasing to a maximum of 10%.



Job specification

Job description

Job title	Project Support Officer		
Directorate	Technology		
Team	Project Management Office (PMO)		
Reporting to	PMO Manager	No. of direct reports	0
Agility contract type	Blended		
Location	Dual location - London office (NW1 7AW) and home		
Budgetary responsibility	NA		
Job level	6	Date	July 2024

Role summary

British Heart Foundation (BHF) is one of the leading charities in the UK and has an ambitious strategy to continue and accelerate the impact that we have on those people living with heart and circulatory diseases.

To support our ambitious portfolio of change the Project Support Officer will support workstreams within a strategic programme. Main functions include coordination of project information for internal and external project stakeholders; provide key communication updates; monitor work and progress against plans; offer vital assistance to project management team; prepare reports and supporting documentation, prepare project board meetings, and ensure projects remain compliant with PMO standards at all times.

This is an exciting opportunity for anyone looking to develop a career in project support in a PMO setting.



Key responsibilities

- Ensure the PMO standards and processes are applied and maintained throughout the programme lifecycle.
- Provide best practice PPM assurance and specialist hands-on support and advice as required.
- Assist the Project Manager with the production and maintenance of plans
- Maintain the project library and filing using the SharePoint project document repository and ensuring the required project documents at each stage of the project lifecycle are completed, quality checked, and contain the correct level of authorisation.
- Act as the secretariat for meetings and boards; scheduling and administration of meetings, co-ordination and distribution of the agenda and taking minutes, notes and actions.
- Co-ordinate the production and distribution of all reports and produce project status report using the BHF's PPM tool.
- Maintain systems for recording project costs, working with Finance to track project costs and bills
- Ensure project documentation compliance and procedures follow PMO defined stage gate review process and schedule stage reviews with PMO at phase transition.
- Advise and assist project team members in the application of project procedures disciplines and recording and reporting standards.
- Track and maintain specific project logs such as the RAID log and the benefits register.
- Develop and support effective communication mechanisms between the project teams.
- Act as the central point of contact for the project and deputise for PM when cover is required.
- Support the delivery of project communications and engagement activity for key stakeholders - draft communication material as required, manage the logistical delivery of engagement events
- Assist the business change and training managers with the preparation and delivery of training content and activity
- Undertake any other activities as specified by the Project or PMO Managers.



Person specification

Knowledge, training and qualifications

- PRINCE2 Foundation or equivalent programme management training and able to demonstrate a track record of working in project and/or programme support
 - Understanding of Agile approaches and concepts
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Experience

Essential

- Experience of successfully working on complex and diverse programmes in large organisations in a programme / programme support role
- Experience of working with a wide variety of internal and external stakeholders, including senior management
- Experience of managing programme financials, tracking and billing
- Highly IT literate with extensive practical experience of the Microsoft Office Suite of applications including Programme, PowerPoint, Visio and SharePoint as well as MS collaboration tools such as MS Teams and PPM tools.

Desirable

- Experience of working in partnership with multiple stakeholders
 - Developing presentations and written content for diverse audiences and communication channels
 - Understanding of business change management methodology and key principles for stakeholder engagement
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Skills and attributes

- A positive 'can-do' attitude and flexible approach
 - High-quality project and programme support skills
 - Exceptional organisational skills
 - Adept at a process-driven approach with strong attention to detail
 - Motivated, self-starter who can easily priorities and manage workloads
 - Personal drive to achieve results and effect change
 - Able to interpret and expand on a brief
 - Able to provide objective advice and persuade/influence at all levels
 - A confident presenter, comfortable working with others to produce content
 - Strong communication skills, both in writing and verbally
 - Able to work effectively as part of a 'virtual' team
 - Able to use initiative, recognise issues as they arise and deal with them in a timely manner
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Safeguarding

At British Heart Foundation (BHF), we are committed to creating a safe and rewarding environment for all of our people to work and volunteer. This means we have a robust safeguarding policy to ensure everyone is treated properly, and a whistle blowing service so people can raise any concerns they have confidentially.



How to apply

To apply for this role please use the apply button via the jobs page on our website. Our process involves submitting your CV and a supporting statement, which should outline your interest and explain how you meet the criteria stated in the person specification.

All applications are managed by our Recruitment team. If you wish to speak with a member of the team regarding the role and your application please contact them on careers@bhf.org.uk

Early application is encouraged as we will review applications throughout the advertising period and reserve the right to close the advert early should we receive a sufficient number of applications.

Should you need any adjustments to the recruitment process at application stage please contact the Recruitment team on careers@bhf.org.uk



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